

THE THRIVE CYCLE

Doing what you're best at when you're at your best.

THE MAXIM

Live in a way today that will help you thrive tomorrow.

I

DIAGNOSE

Name the Stress Spiral.

Stop pretending it's just a busy season.

CHAPTERS

Ch 1

Ch 2

II

FOCUS YOUR TIME

Tell the truth about time.

Find your three to five Green Zone hours.

CHAPTERS

Ch 3

Ch 4

III

LEVERAGE YOUR ENERGY

Do what you're best at when you're at your best.

Match tasks to zones.

CHAPTERS

Ch 5

Ch 6

IV

REALIZE YOUR PRIORITIES

Defend your Green Zone.

From tasks, distractions, and people.

CHAPTERS

Ch 7

Ch 8

Ch 9

V

SYNC & SUSTAIN

Build a Thrive Calendar. Recalibrate fast.

Become who you're meant to be.

CHAPTERS

Ch 10

Ch 11

Ch 12

WHEN THE THRIVE CYCLE IS WORKING

1. Priorities done
2. Gift developing
3. Meetings energize
4. Family has you
5. You're happier

THE THRIVE ACTION CARD

What to put in each zone — and what to keep out.

GREEN ZONE

3–5 peak hours. Your treasure.

PUT HERE

- Your highest-impact work
- Develop your gift (not just deploy)
- Deep thinking, writing, strategy
- Top performers (1:1)
- Your inner 3–5 people
- Breakthrough creative work

KEEP OUT

- × Inbox clearing
- × Routine meetings
- × Errands or admin
- × Breakfast meetings

YELLOW ZONE

Mid energy. Most of your day.

PUT HERE

- Most meetings (decent fit)
- Email triage
- Calendar & planning
- Routine project work
- Sympathy 12–15 connections
- Podcasts, interviews, calls

KEEP OUT

- × Mission-critical thinking
- × Hiring decisions
- × Emotionally hard conversations

RED ZONE

Low energy. Coast carefully.

PUT HERE

- Low-stakes admin & expenses
- Filing, organizing, cleanup
- Exercise (often re-energizes)
- Routine errands
- Mindless tasks you don't love

KEEP OUT

- × Important decisions
- × Sensitive emails to teams
- × Conflict or tough feedback
- × Anything that really matters

THE CLEAR NO · Five Steps

1

AFFIRM

"I'd love to."

2

EMPATHIZE

"I see why this matters."

3

BE FIRM

"I'm going to pass."

4

REDIRECT

"Here's a better fit."

5

THANK

"Grateful you asked."

THE THREE RATIOS · Do the Math

1

ALONE vs. PEOPLE

What mix lets you thrive? Mine ≈ 60/40. Find yours.

2

WEEKLY MEETING CAP

A maximum number per week beyond which work suffers.

3

HOME vs. ON THE ROAD

Travel multiplies fatigue. Notice your ceiling.